RESEARCH UPDATE · 1 NOV 2026

Our tests said PASS.
Our grader said FAIL.

This happened in nine runs where AI tried to fix code.

OUR TESTS: PASS → FINAL SCORE: FAIL

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What was the AI doing?

1. See a small code problem
2. Write a possible fix
3. Hear PASS or FAIL
4. Stop or try again

This can happen several times in one run.

Source: paper/final.md, Methods; README.md.

IMAGINE THIS

A teacher checks every box...

THE CHECKLIST

✓ ✓ ✓

All listed checks pass.

→

THE FINAL GRADE

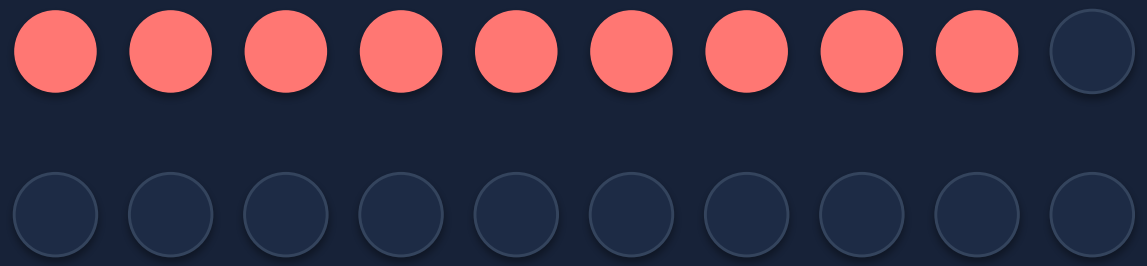
FAIL

Another rule says no.

The checklist covers only the things it checks.

Analogy of the historical checker; source: paper/final.md, Results.

Nine times, tests and score disagreed



20 runs had the extra "no" rule

9 of 20

passed our written tests but still got FAIL

We reviewed 40 AI runs in total.

Source: docs/MEASUREMENT_FOLLOWUP_20261030.md, §1; paper/final.md, Results.

WHY

Our checker had an extra rule

WRITTEN TESTS

PASS

+

OUR EXTRA RULE

NO

= FINAL FAIL

We added that rule. The AI did not see it.

Source: paper/final.md, Results; docs/PROJECT_OVERVIEW_20261029.md.

SO WHAT?

The score can mislead us

THE SCORE SEEMS TO SAY

"The AI failed."

OUR RECORDS SHOW

The tests and score disagreed.

So this score cannot tell us whether the AI should have stopped trying.

Passing our small tests does not prove the code fully safe.

Source: paper/final.md, Discussion and limitations.

OUR PROGRESS

What we have done so far

40 old AI runs checked again

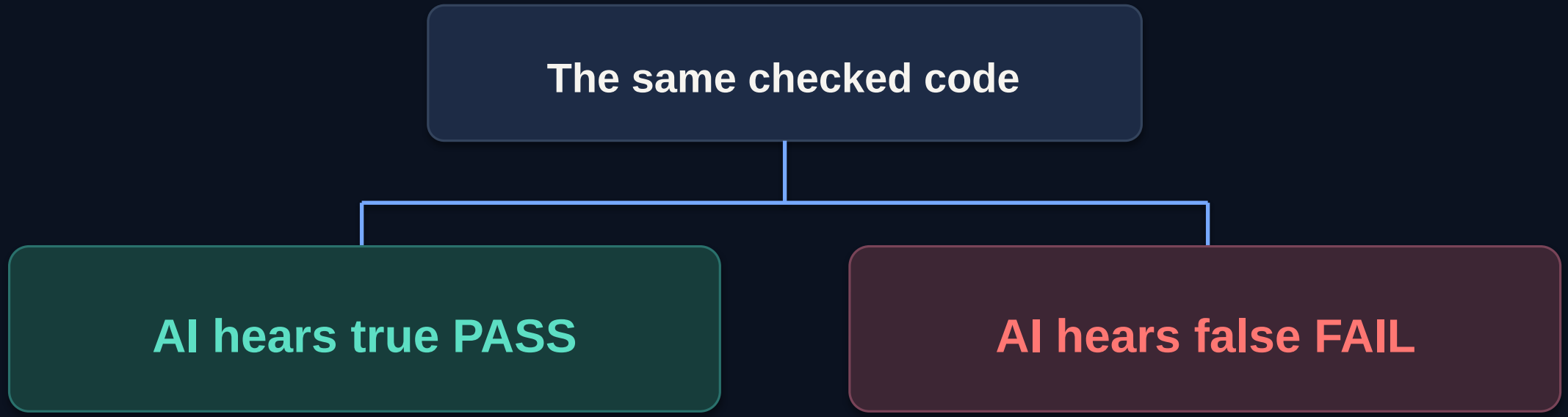
20 new kinds of tasks drafted

30 separate practice runs completed

✓ code and analyses shared online

Sources: README.md; docs/MEASUREMENT_FOLLOWUP_20261030.md; docs/V7_DECISIVE_EXCLUDED_PILOT_20261005.md.

Same code. Two different messages.



Does the wrong message make it lose the fix?

PLANNED: this larger test has no results yet.

Before judging the AI, check the grader.

github.com/Imranqsl212/AiResearch